sure sign that I've had a big night. No doubt I was tired, but in a way that helped. I didn't run a hell of a lot that day. I just stood there and teed off. After I was out, Bouchie's gutsy 50 off 43 balls saw us home to a win that's universally acknowledged as the greatest game of cricket ever played.

I subsequently discovered that the Proteas team management had found out about my drunken night and were planning to kak me out after the game. Mickey actually said to me, 'Hersch, I was going to give you the biggest lecture of your life, but now, how can I?' He was laughing as he said it. That evening we had the biggest fines meeting ever. As I mention elsewhere, it was the first time I ever saw Mickey Arthur so drunk that he threw up.

The 2009 Indian Premier League final

To be honest, I still don't know how we, the Deccan Chargers, won the damn thing in 2009. As you know, the series was moved to South Africa for safety reasons, and our opening game in Cape Town was against the Kolkata Knight Riders. I think that game set the tone for us. It was an unbelievable effort. For one thing, I've never seen a fielding display in a similar vein from an IPL team. I've seen it playing for the Proteas at times, but on that particular day … man, everything just stuck. I took a good catch to get Brad Hodge, Rohit Sharma took a brilliant catch to get Moisés Henriques, and he also ran out Ajit Agarkar.

This was our current fielding coach Mike Young's first game as part of the Chargers squad and he was like, 'If this is the standard you've already got going, then what the hell am I doing here?' It was just that good. The intensity, the energy … everything … That game set the standard and we got off to a flyer. We won four games in a row before hitting a bit of a wobble. Then Adam Gilchrist basically won the semi-final against the Delhi Daredevils on his own, with an unbelievable knock of 85. He took Dirk 'Diggler' Nannes for 20 in his first over, and that took the wind out of their sails completely, because obviously the Devils used him to strike early on. Gilly just klapped him, and after that they didn't have an answer. And then I took care of the final.

Playing for the Deccan Chargers against the Royal Challengers Bangalore in the 2009 IPL final was one game that proved just how unpredictable finals can be. This is where you find out which guys can or can't handle the pressure.